

Thirteenth Sunday in Ordinary Time

Year A

PC-S37-A

Textual unit	Text / citation
Introductory Rites	
Entrance Antiphon	Ps. 47:2
Collect	<i>Deus, qui, per adoptionem gratiae, lucis nos esse filios voluisti</i>
Liturgy of the Word	
First Reading	2 Kgs. 4:8–11, 14–16a
Responsorial Psalm	Ps. 89:2–3, 16–17, 18–19; response 2a
Second Reading	Rom. 6:3–4, 8–11
Gospel Acclamation	1 Pet. 2:9
Gospel	Matt. 10:37–42
Liturgy of the Eucharist	
Prayer over Offerings	<i>Deus, qui mysteriorum tuorum... operaris effectus</i>
Communion Antiphon	A: cf. Ps. 103:1; B: John 17:20–21
Prayer after Communion	<i>Vivificet nos... divina quam obtulimus et sumpsimus hostia</i>

Sense	Synthesis
Literal	The Shunammite welcomes Elisha and receives a promise; Jesus orders every bond under allegiance to him and promises that receiving his messenger receives him; Paul recalls Baptism into Christ's death and life.
Allegorical	Christ, received in his messengers and sacramental mysteries, draws a called people from darkness into light and unites them to his Paschal life and enduring charity.
Moral	Prefer Christ without despising creaturely duties; carry the cross without seeking harm; practice prudent hospitality even in a cup of water; live the baptismal death to sin.
Anagogical	Those dead with Christ hope to live with him; mercy is sung forever, faithful service receives its reward, and Communion gives life ordered to lasting union in charity.

Scriptural Date and Location

Canonical order governs; composition and narrated event remain distinct, and inherited and modern judgments remain separate where the evidence is uncertain.

Textual unit / alternative	Citation	Location	Date
First Reading	2 Kgs. 4:8–11, 14–16a	Judah or Babylonian exile horizon; exact place of final formation unresolved	Exilic or early postexilic final form; precise date unresolved
Narrated event	2 Kgs. 4:8–37	Shunem, northern kingdom of Israel	Ninth century BC; precise date not recoverable
Kings is received prophetic history; modern study locates its Deuteronomistic formation across monarchic and exilic transmission. Event: at Shunem (modern Sulam), a prominent woman provides a permanent upper room; the promise belongs to a longer birth–death–restoration story.			
Entrance	Ps. 47:2	Israel’s worship; exact writing place unknown	Korahite title; historical date uncertain
The sons-of-Korah psalm acclaims God’s universal kingship. Its Entrance use summons all peoples; it does not establish original composition for the Week XIII formulary.			
Responsorial Psalm	Ps. 89:2–3, 16–17, 18–19	Israel / Jerusalem royal and covenant horizon	Title names Ethan the Ezrahite; date uncertain
Enduring covenant mercy precedes lament over the fallen Davidic king. Appointed verses retain praise, worship, and God-given strength while omitting that lament; the canonical tension remains relevant.			
Comm. A	Ps. 103:1	Israel; exact place unknown	Traditional Davidic attribution; historical date uncertain
The whole self is called to bless and remember; forgiveness, healing, compassion, and creaturely dependence follow. Communion A appoints the opening summons.			
Gospel	Matt. 10:37–42	Canonical Gospel: traditional Palestine; modern Antioch proposal uncertain	Traditionally early apostolic period; modern majority c. AD 80–90
Narrated event	Matt. 4:23; 10:1–42	Galilee; exact speaking site unrecorded	Public ministry, c. AD 28–29
Tradition: the Apostle Matthew writing for Jewish believers. Modern judgment: the canonical Greek Gospel after AD 70. The missionary discourse closes by moving from costly allegiance and the cross to receiving apostles, prophets, righteous persons, and little ones.			
Comm. B	John 17:20–21	Canonical Gospel: traditional Ephesus; modern history debated	Late first century
Narrated event	John 13:1; 17:1–26	Jerusalem, final supper	c. AD 29–30
Tradition associates the Apostle John with Ephesus. Christ’s prayer reaches future believers and orders unity toward the world’s belief. The Missal appoints it as Communion B.			
Second Reading	Rom. 6:3–4, 8–11	Corinth, Achaia (present-day Greece), to churches at Rome	c. AD 56–58
Paul rejects the inference that abundant grace licenses sin. Baptism joins believers to Christ’s death and burial and orders new life; the reading omits vv. 5–7, then resumes with dying and living with Christ.			
Acclamation	1 Pet. 2:9	From “Babylon” (received as Rome) to Christians in Asia Minor	Traditional Petrine setting in AD 60s; authorship and date disputed
Audience: Pontus, Galatia, Cappadocia, Asia, and Bithynia. Royal-priestly and holy-nation language receives Exodus in Christological ecclesial identity; the clause calls from darkness to light and to proclamation of God’s mighty acts.			

The Propers: Themes and Movement

Governing account: receive Christ, lose the false life, live from his gift

The Lectionary officially joins the Shunammite's welcome of Elisha to Jesus' promise that receiving his messenger receives him. Romans contributes an independent baptismal death-and-life strand, 1 Peter acclaims a called people brought into light, and the Missal frames these with adoption, truth, divinely effected mysteries, remembered benefits, ecclesial unity, and life in lasting charity.

Called into light → Christ preferred → messenger received → life renewed

1. Gift establishes the household (*Entrance, Collect, Acclamation*)

The universal acclamation of Psalm 47 opens into the Collect's adoption by grace. The assembly does not generate light but is made children of light and asked to adhere to truth. First Peter gives this identity a vocation: those called from darkness proclaim God's mighty acts. Belonging becomes testimony.

2. Hospitality receives more than it controls (*First Reading, Psalm, Gospel*)

The Shunammite recognizes Elisha, makes space, and receives a promise she did not manipulate. Matthew explicitly correlates receiving a prophet, righteous person, or little one with receiving Christ and the One who sent him. Psalm 89 answers in covenant mercy and blessed worship. Hospitality is receptive participation, never a transaction for guaranteed reward.

3. The cross orders every love (*Gospel, Romans*)

Jesus' priority does not abolish family love; it judges and orders every creaturely attachment under love of God. Taking the cross and losing life are costly fidelity, not self-harm. Romans independently names the sacramental foundation of Christian death and life: Baptism joins believers to Christ's once-for-all Pasch and summons continuing death to sin.

4. God effects and Communion gives life (*Prayer over Offerings, Communion, Prayer after Communion*)

The offering prayer attributes the mysteries' effect to God while asking that servants celebrate worthily. Communion may remember divine benefits or voice Christ's prayer for unity. The final prayer names the offered and received victim as life-giving and orders union toward lasting charity. This sacramental movement can illuminate Romans, but its Week XIII texts are shared across all cycles.

Pastoral control

Christ's priority never licenses neglect of children, spouse, parents, dependents, safeguarding, or lawful duties. The cross is not avoidable injury sought for itself. Hospitality does not suspend prudence or make access to vulnerable persons a religious entitlement. Baptismal identity grounds conversion; it does not make future sin impossible.

Theological and Spiritual Synthesis

The variable texts describe Christian life as received participation in Christ. The Shunammite welcomes God's messenger and receives a promise; Jesus orders every bond under allegiance to himself and identifies reception of his messengers with reception of him; Paul recalls Baptism into Christ's death and risen life. The Collect and acclamation place this movement within adoption by grace and vocation from darkness into light.

Such participation orders rather than destroys creaturely love: Christ is preferred without contempt for duty, the cross is carried without seeking harm, and hospitality remains prudent even in its smallest acts. The offering and Communion texts locate this discipleship within mysteries God effects, grateful remembrance or ecclesial unity, life from Christ's sacrifice, and lasting charity. Those who die with Christ live toward enduring communion in him.

Dimension	Appointed anchors	Source-grounded synthesis	Limit
Christological	Matt. 10:37–42; Rom. 6:3–4, 8–11; Prayer after Communion	Christ orders every creaturely bond, joins the baptized to his death and risen life, and gives life through the offered and received sacrificial gift.	Romans remains a semi-continuous strand; the matrix does not claim that it was selected to explain Matthew's cross saying.
Ecclesial	Collect; 1 Pet. 2:9; Gospel; Communion B	Children of light are called to proclaim God's acts, receive Christ in his messengers, and seek the unity for which Christ prays.	Communion B is an unselected alternative, and reception of a messenger never grants unlimited access or suspends discernment and safeguarding.
Sacramental	Rom. 6:3–4, 8–11; Prayer over Offerings; Prayer after Communion	Baptism joins believers to Christ's Pasch; God effects the mysteries, and Eucharistic reception gives life ordered to lasting charity.	Baptismal identity requires continuing conversion, and the shared Week XIII orations do not prove a cycle-specific compositional plan.
Moral and eschatological	2 Kgs. 4:8–11, 14–16a; Ps. 89; Gospel; Communion A	Prudent hospitality, rightly ordered love, small acts of service, remembered benefits, and mercy sung forever tend toward reward and life with Christ.	Communion A is unselected; hospitality is not a transaction for miracles, allegiance does not erase lawful duties, and the cross never commends self-harm or avoidable danger.

The Propers: Detailed Commentary

Kingship, adoption, light, and truth (*Entrance, Collect, Acclamation*)

Psalm 47's worldwide summons gives the Entrance a public horizon: the God acclaimed by all peoples is king over all the earth. The Collect narrows that grandeur to filial gift. Adoption is by grace, so "children of light" names received identity rather than spiritual pedigree. The petition to avoid error and adhere to truth also prevents light language from becoming mere inward feeling.

First Peter's acclamation receives Israel's royal-priestly vocabulary within a Christological address to baptized communities. Its purpose is proclamation of God's mighty acts, not self-congratulation.

A room, a promise, and a received messenger (*First Reading, Psalm, Gospel*)

The Shunammite's hospitality is concrete and sustained: food, recognition, household consultation, and a small furnished room. The appointed omissions move from her welcome to Elisha's question about recompense and the servant's observation that she has no son. The promise is gift, not payment produced by a technique. The larger narrative, in which the son later dies and is restored, intensifies the story's dependence on God beyond the selected verses.

Psalm 89 praises mercy forever, confesses a covenant, blesses those who know the festal cry, and identifies God as strength and shield. Yet the full psalm later laments apparent collapse of the Davidic promise. The response is therefore praise with eschatological tension, not evidence that covenant life is free of contradiction or grief.

Matthew ends the missionary discourse by making reception relationally deep: receiving the apostolic messenger receives Christ, and receiving Christ reaches the Father who sent him. Chrysostom guards the dignity of apparently small persons and acts. Prophet, righteous person, disciple, and giver of water all enter a chain in which Christ takes the treatment of his servants personally.

This does not confer unlimited access or make every claimant a trustworthy messenger. Ecclesial authority, discernment, safeguarding, and prudence remain necessary. Nor is reward commercial payment. The cup matters because it is given in the name of discipleship; grace dignifies the person and act beyond their visible scale.

Christ before family and the cross without self-harm (*Gospel*)

Jesus' comparative saying demands supreme allegiance. Chrysostom interprets it as preferring the Creator when creaturely attachment conflicts with discipleship, not hating parents as such. Elsewhere Matthew condemns evasion of duties to father and mother. The hard saying therefore orders loves: family is loved truthfully under God, never made an absolute rival and never discarded as though grace opposed nature.

Taking one's cross is readiness for faithful suffering in union with Christ. It does not sacralize abuse, disable self-protection, or turn preventable injury into a spiritual achievement. Losing life for Christ can include martyrial fidelity and daily self-gift, but cannot be invoked to command another person's silence or exposure.

Baptized into death and life (*Second Reading*)

Romans 6 begins from sacramental fact. Baptism joins believers to Christ's death and burial so that their life may correspond to his resurrection. Paul is not describing a private symbol chosen after conversion; he appeals to a common ecclesial initiation that changes the believer's relation to sin and to Christ.

The appointed boundary requires care. Verses 5–7, with further explanation of union and freedom, are omitted; verses 8–11 resume the movement to living with Christ and reckoning oneself dead to sin. Chrysostom distinguishes Christ's bodily death from the baptized person's death to sin, while joining both through sacramental participation. The once-for-all death of Christ grounds rather than removes ongoing fidelity.

Romans remains semi-continuous. A cross-Baptism connection with Matthew is theologically plausible and canonically grounded, but the Lectionary's Ordinary Time principles do not establish that the second reading was selected to comment on this Gospel. The guide therefore reserves claims of one designed sequence.

Mysteries effected by God (*Prayer over Offerings*)

The Prayer over the Offerings assigns sacramental effect to God and asks that the Church's service accord with the mysteries. Divine efficacy and human disposition are related without competition: God acts first and truly; worshippers are genuinely called to worthy service.

Remembered benefits, unity, life, and charity (*Communion, Prayer after Communion*)

Communion option A begins Psalm 103's self-address: the whole person blesses God and refuses forgetfulness of his benefits. Option B carries Christ's prayer that later believers be one so the world may believe. Both are appointed textual alternatives.

The Prayer after Communion identifies the Eucharistic gift christologically as the offered and received divine victim and asks that it give life. Its horizon is not isolated vitality but union in lasting charity. If option B is used, ecclesial unity forms an unusually explicit arc. If option A is used, grateful memory comes forward. The concluding prayer remains common to both.

The Propers: Interpretive Possibilities

Editorial status

The following are original editorial or AI-generated possibilities. They are attributed to none of the cited authorities and claim no historical compositional intent. Each states its anchors and limits.

The prepared room as disciplined availability. (*2 Kings, Gospel*) The Shunammite's modest, durable space and Jesus' cup of water may suggest that hospitality often becomes holy through repeatable structures rather than dramatic sentiment. This is analogy, not a promise that generosity produces miracles, and safe boundaries remain integral to genuine welcome.

Baptism as the measure of costly allegiance. (*Romans, Gospel*) The independent Pauline strand may discipline the Gospel's "losing life": Christian self-loss is participation in Christ's once-for-all Pasch and death to sin, not annihilation of personality or duties. The proposal does not claim Lectionary selection intent and cannot justify self-harm.

Unity as hospitable reception. (*Gospel, Communion B*) Receiving Christ in his messengers and Christ's prayer that believers be one may illuminate unity as making room for graced difference under one Lord. This possibility belongs specifically to Communion alternative B, and unity never requires overlooking falsehood, danger, or injustice.

Appendix: Liturgical Resolution

Liturgical Instance

Field	Resolved liturgical instance
Formula and occurrence	PC-S37-A; Sunday Mass for the Thirteenth Sunday in Ordinary Time; 28 June 2026; green.
Books and territory	<i>Roman Missal, Third Edition</i> , English for the United States (implemented 2011), and U.S. <i>Lectionary for Mass</i> , Second Typical Edition, Volume I, no. 97.
Calendar and cycle	U.S. implementation of the General Roman Calendar; Sunday Year A.
Formulary and textual scope	Ordinary Time Week XIII. Its shared audit owns the Missal formulary; this leaf owns the dated Year A composition and its two Communion-antiphon alternatives.

Branch Resolution

Branch ID	Authority and trigger	Status	Units affected	Resolution
communion-antiphon-psalm-103	Week XIII formulary	Appointed alternative	Psalms 103 option	Documented, not selected
communion-antiphon-john-17	Week XIII formulary	Appointed alternative	John 17 option	Documented, not selected

Appendix: Scope and Qualifications

Instance: instance/manifest.md. **Leaf composition audit:** propers/verified.md. **Canonical formulary owner:** ../shared/ordinary-time/weeks/13/propers/verified.md. **Research audit:** research/scope.md. **Coverage:** the complete formula and branches, official dated Lectionary path, immediate biblical contexts, direct Chrysostom reception of Matthew and Romans, Augustine on Psalm 89, and baptismal doctrine were studied. **Negative result:** no direct patristic exposition of 2 Kings 4:8–16a was retained. **Limits:** no exhaustive manuscript, untranslated-corpus, subscription-database, or proper-calendar survey is claimed. Complete U.S. English altar-book oration collation and independent theological review remain outstanding.

References

- USCCB, Thirteenth Sunday in Ordinary Time, 28 June 2026, U.S. Lectionary 97; and 2026 Liturgical Calendar, accessed 2026-07-15.
- *Missale Romanum*, editio typica tertia (2002), p. 463; reimpressio emendata (2008); and *Roman Missal, Third Edition*, U.S. English edition implemented 2011.
- Bishops’ Conference of England and Wales, *Antiphony: Excerpted from the Roman Missal* (ICEL, 2010), p. 73, used as official corroboration of the common ICEL antiphons, not as a substitute U.S. altar book.
- *General Instruction of the Roman Missal* 46–90; *General Introduction to the Lectionary* 65–69, 78–91, 93–110.
- St. John Chrysostom, *Homily 35 on Matthew; Homily 10 on Romans; Homily 11 on Romans*.
- St. Augustine, *Exposition on Psalm 89; Catechism of the Catholic Church* 1213, 1227, 1265–1270.

Generation Metadata

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Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (structural audit, document-revision, and production roles); Codex CLI 0.144.5; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agent (reader-order structural revision: moved and retitled the unchanged scriptural chronology and location sheet and set its page boundaries); Codex CLI 0.144.5; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agent (one-page dossier compaction, visual QA, and page-break repair roles); API workspace; unexposed: client version, interface, and server revision

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